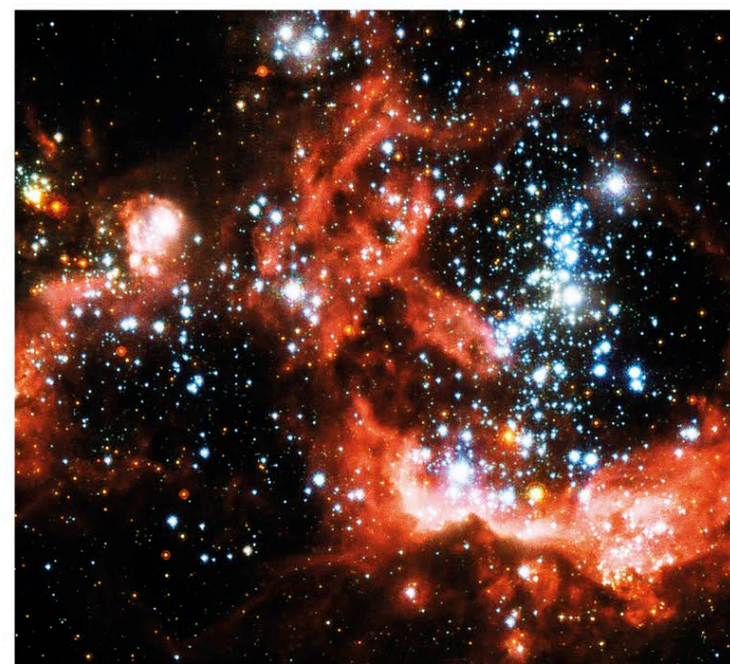


TRIANGULUM

THE TRIANGLE

THOUGH THIS ELONGATED TRIANGLE IS DRAWN AROUND THREE INSIGNIFICANT STARS, IT IS EASY TO SPOT BECAUSE OF ITS COMPACT SIZE. THE NEARBY SPIRAL GALAXY M33 IS THIS NORTHERN CONSTELLATION'S FINEST SIGHT.

More than 2,000 years ago this three-sided star pattern was imagined variously as the Greek capital letter Delta, the Nile river delta, and the island of Sicily. A fourth option—an isosceles triangle—prevailed and this is how the constellation is seen today. It is home to the spiral galaxy M33, better known as the Triangulum Galaxy. It is the third-largest member of our Local Group of galaxies and, at 2.7 million light-years away, is one of the closest.



△ NGC 604

The huge billowing cloud of hydrogen in M33 is 1,500 light-years across and a center of star formation. Its red glow is a product of the ultraviolet energy released by hundreds of young, bright stars.

▷ M33

Galaxy M33 lies almost face-on to Earth and its arms are, in fact, a series of separate patches. The galaxy is one of the most distant objects visible to the naked eye, as long as conditions are good.



KEY DATA

Size ranking 78

Brightest stars Beta (β)
3.0, Alpha (α) 3.4

Genitive Trianguli

Abbreviation Tri

Highest in sky at 10pm
November–December

Fully visible 90°N–52°S



CHART 3

MAIN STARS

Alpha (α) Trianguli
White giant or subgiant

☼ 3.4 ↔ 63 light-years

Beta (β) Trianguli
White subgiant

☼ 3.0 ↔ 130 light-years

Gamma (γ) Trianguli
White main-sequence star

☼ 4.0 ↔ 112 light-years

6 Trianguli
Yellow giant, and a double star

☼ 5.0 ↔ 290 light-years

R Trianguli
Red giant star, also a variable star

☼ 6.8 ↔ 960 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

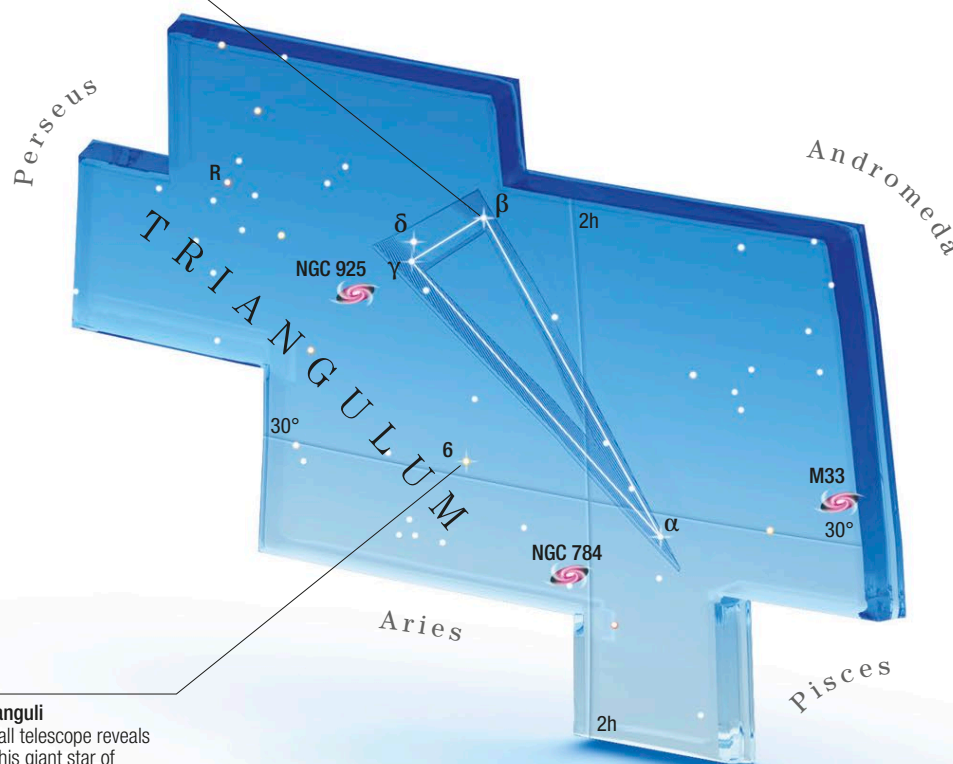
M33 (Triangulum Galaxy)
Spiral galaxy, also known as NGC 598

NGC 604
Star-formation nebula in M33

NGC 784
Barred spiral galaxy

NGC 925
Barred spiral galaxy

Beta (β) Trianguli
At magnitude 3.0 this is the brightest star in Triangulum. It is a white star about four times the width of the Sun



6 Trianguli
A small telescope reveals that this giant star of magnitude 5.0 has a companion, a 7th-magnitude white main-sequence star